

EG US Daily: McMorrow's exit is not enough for Democratic certainty in Michigan

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【要点】

- ・ ミシガン州民主党上院予備選でマクモローの撤退により、進歩派候補エル・セイドと中道派候補スティーブンスの一騎打ちになったが、支持者の流れが不確実でどちらが有利になるか不明。
- ・ ミシガンは民主党が上院多数派を獲得するために必須の州であり、エル・セイドが指名されると共和党の勝利可能性が高まるため、民主党にとって不利となる。
- ・ 両候補はスティーブンスが州司法長官の推薦と3,000万ドルの州外広告資金を獲得する一方、エル・セイドはAOCの推薦を得るなど外部支援の獲得に注力している。
- ・ トランプ大統領のNATO首脳会談での圧力戦略は、NATO全体からの撤退という広範な脅迫から、協力的でない加盟国への個別的な強制へとシフトしている。
- ・ イラン問題がこの戦略転換の中心で、ヘグセス国防長官が米軍の基地利用やシナイ空域へのアクセスを拒否した加盟国に兵力削減で脅している。

【メール原文】

US Daily

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McMorrow's exit is not enough for Democratic certainty in Michigan

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- * McMorrow's exit is not enough for Democratic certainty in Michigan
 - * Targeted coercion, not broad threats of pullback, will define US approach to NATO summit
 - * Divided Congress will be the largest hurdle for Open AI's wealth fund idea
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McMorrow's exit is not enough for Democratic certainty in Michigan. The exit of State Sen. Mallory McMorrow from the Michigan Democratic Senate primary narrows the field to a clean contest between a progressive candidate, Abdul El-Sayed, and a centrist one, Rep. Haley Stevens. While Stevens is a more viable candidate in the general election, El-Sayed remains a strong candidate in the primary—he has narrowly led most polls of the race for the past few months—and it is unclear who will benefit from McMorrow's departure.

* Michigan is a must-win race if Democrats seek to take the Senate in the fall (40% odds); an El-Sayed nomination would boost Republicans' chance of winning the seat. If Republicans win in Michigan, Democrats would have to flip five out of the six Republican seats up for grabs in North Carolina, Maine, Iowa, Ohio, Alaska, and Texas to win a Senate majority, an unlikely course of events.

* McMorrow tried to stake out a middle ground in the race, billing herself as a progressive who was not as far left as El-Sayed. It's therefore difficult to tell where her supporters—8% of the field in recent polls, compared to El-Sayed's 41% and Stevens's 36%—will flow to, especially as McMorrow herself has not immediately endorsed one of the other candidates.

* With the election in just under a month, both remaining candidates are focusing on lining up outside support to boost their image. McMorrow's exit led Michigan's Attorney General to endorse Stevens, who is also benefiting from \$30 million in out-of-state ad buys; El-Sayed last week picked up an endorsement from Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D-NY).

Targeted coercion, not broad threats of pullback, will define US approach to NATO summit. Trump's visit to the NATO summit in Turkey this week will feature a rehash of familiar themes—the US-NATO relationship is one sided, the US shouldn't carry as much of the burden for European defense—but Trump will focus his pressure on individual states he views as uncooperative rather than the institution as a whole.

* This is another step in the evolving US approach to NATO, which is moving away from threats to withdraw broadly and toward efforts to focus on benefitting specific states within NATO; in effect, moving toward a world where the US builds coalitions within the coalition.

* Iran is the nexus of this split, with Trump and Secretary of Defense Hegseth targeting states that refused basing and airspace access for US forces with threats of troop reduction. Hegseth's announcement of a 6-month review of forces is an effort to formalize this threat, though the actual ability of the US to redeploy forces within Europe is limited by logistical and operational realities.

* Politically, Trump faces pushback from within the GOP for his more aggressive critiques of NATO, and limitations from Congress on how far troop reductions can actually go (to a floor of 76,000, around 10,000 more than were deployed to Europe before the war in Ukraine). However, with Trump increasingly estranged from his own party's members—especially in the relatively more pro-NATO Senate GOP—the domestic political limitations on him may weaken, and his individual relationship with European leaders will likely become the most important factor shaping US policy.

Divided Congress will be the largest hurdle for Open AI's wealth fund idea. Last week, OpenAI's Sam Altman floated a proposal for the artificial intelligence giant, along with its competitors, to voluntarily hand over 5% of their company's stock to be invested in a sovereign wealth fund.

* There is currently no strong legal hurdle barring OpenAI or other firms from gifting stocks to the U.S. government. However, although there is no consensus on the seriousness of the proposal now, congressional action would be required for all the ensuing steps of Altman's proposal in the future, including standing up a wealth fund to return dividends to Americans.

* The Trump administration's existing stakes in rare earth and semiconductor firms have been acquired through preexisting appropriations and authorities, such as the Defense Production Act's Title III, the CHIPS Act, and the DOD's Other Transaction Authority (OTA). However, these arrangements sit in a

legal grey area and risk judicial scrutiny from the Supreme Court.

* Whether through a sovereign wealth fund or a new Treasury fund, all pooled investment vehicles for the AI stocks will require a new legal entity, appropriations, divestment procedures, disbursal authority for dividends, and new governance rules.

* Congress is currently exploring avenues to codify authorities for the executive to buy and sell stocks through provisions in the year-end NDAA, including a provision establishing a Defense Equity Investment Account at Treasury for critical minerals, materials, and chemical companies. However, as congressional Democrats seek to rein in Trump's executive power, amendments to the bill expanding executive authorities will face political headwinds.

Quote of the Day

"And we're going to have a full team, and Belgium is going to have a full team. And you know what? If they beat us, then they can be really proud. The other way, if they beat us, we'll say it was — I'd say— it was rigged, just like the election was rigged in 2020." - Trump speaking to reporters about today's World Cup match between the US and Belgium; Trump personally intervened with FIFA's president Gianni Infantino to allow US striker Folarin Balogun to play in tonight's match, leveraging his eight-year long relationship with Infantino which notably led to his receipt of the inaugural FIFA Peace Prize.

On the Radar

7-8 July: NATO summit in Turkey

13 July: Congress returns from July 4 recess

14 July: Fed chair Kevin Warsh testifies before the House Financial Services Committee.

15 July: Senate Judiciary Committee confirmation hearing for Attorney General nominee Todd Blanche

24 July: Section 122 tariffs expire

4 August: Michigan primary election

3 November: National midterm elections

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Positive: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a positive impact on the macro business environment

Neutral: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a neutral or negligible impact on the macro business environment

Negative: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a negative impact on the macro business environment

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